

Week 6 — Survive the Crit

Muhammad Ayyan Hassan

1. Portfolio Submitted for Review

Live portfolio: <https://ayyan-hassan-portfolio.vercel.app/>

Review basis: The review used the live portfolio and the previously locked Week 3 portfolio direction, including the one-line claim, content map, CTA ladder, evidence decisions, and visual identity.

2. Proof Statement

I find and exploit vulnerabilities in web applications, document the evidence, and explain why they matter — using AI as an analytical partner, not a shortcut.

The portfolio is designed to make that claim credible through hands-on XSS and SQL injection work, with the reasoning and evidence behind the work shown rather than relying on a title alone.

3. Reviewer

Reviewer type: AI-assisted senior product/design engineering review. AI review was used because the assignment permits it. The reviewer was instructed to behave as a first-time senior reviewer, avoid generic praise, judge the site against its actual job, and give direct feedback without trying to redesign it for personal taste.

4. The Two Required 10-Second Questions

Question 1 — In ten seconds, what do I do?

“I can tell this is Ayyan’s portfolio, but the original version did not make his actual technical focus clear quickly enough. It communicated identity and contact information more strongly than capability. I had to infer the security focus instead of being told it immediately.”

Question 2 — Would you believe I’m good at it?

“Not from the original landing page alone. The visual direction felt deliberate, but there was not enough visible work or evidence near the entry point to judge capability. The strongest proof is the security work itself — especially the XSS process — so the portfolio needed to bring that evidence closer to the claim.”

5. Additional Reviewer Feedback

Must-fix: The portfolio felt closer to a contact/identity page than a finished portfolio.

Must-fix: The security focus was not obvious enough in the first few seconds.

Must-fix: The work/proof was not prominent enough before the contact action.

Must-fix: The phrase “Portfolio — coming together deliberately” made the site feel unfinished.

Nice-to-have / preserve: The existing restrained typography, spacing, and palette were coherent and should be preserved.

Nice-to-have: The contact copy could become more specific later.

Nice-to-have / defer: Additional animations, decorative graphics, or visual effects could be explored later, but they are not needed to solve the current communication problem.

6. Honest Must-Fix / Nice-to-Have Sort

Feedback	Sort	Reason
Security focus unclear at first glance	MUST-FIX	Fails the required ten-second understanding test.
Work/proof not visible enough	MUST-FIX	A portfolio needs evidence before asking the visitor to contact the author.
Unfinished “coming together” wording	MUST-FIX	Weakens confidence in a portfolio that is being used as professional proof.
Contact too prominent relative to proof	MUST-FIX	Breaks the intended claim → proof → contact journey.
More specific contact wording	NICE-TO-HAVE	Useful refinement, but not the main credibility failure.
Animations / decorative richness	NICE-TO-HAVE	Could be explored later; it does not solve the core communication problem and could conflict with the restrained identity.
Change typography / palette	NOT NEEDED	The existing identity system already supports the intended mood and evidence-led approach.

7. Must-Fixes Implemented

- Replaced the vague/unfinished portfolio introduction with the locked security-focused positioning.
- Moved the first impression toward the actual security claim: web application vulnerabilities, evidence, and reasoning.
- Added a visible Work section so the visitor can move directly from the claim to security proof.
- Made Reflected XSS and SQL injection the featured work directions, matching the previously approved content map.
- Positioned the contact section after the proof and clarified that it is for cybersecurity internship or entry-level opportunities.
- Kept the existing Space Grotesk + Inter typography and Deep Burgundy / Ink / Warm White identity rather than adding unnecessary visual noise.
- Kept the working contact-form implementation intact.

8. Evidence the Must-Fixes Were Addressed

The updated portfolio is live at <https://ayyan-hassan-portfolio.vercel.app/>. After deployment, the live version was checked and the updated security-focused content was visible.

The repository was updated on the main branch. The critique-driven implementation changed the homepage so that the visitor now encounters the security positioning first, followed by Work, About, and Contact.

The implementation also preserves the established visual identity: Space Grotesk for headings/labels, Inter for body/supporting text, and Deep Burgundy #6B1F2A, Ink #171717, and Warm White #F7F5F2.

9. Before → After

Before: Identity and contact were clearer than the actual work. The phrase “Portfolio — coming together deliberately” also suggested an unfinished state.

After: The first impression states the security focus directly, the Work section makes the proof discoverable, and Contact comes after the evidence.

Before: Visitor had to infer what the portfolio was meant to prove.

After: The intended journey is explicit: understand the claim → see the proof → become convinced → contact me.

10. Response to the Crit

I did not try to defend the original design when the review exposed a clarity problem. The visual restraint was intentional, but the review showed that restraint was not enough on its own: the work and proof needed to be easier to find. I kept the identity system and changed the parts that affected understanding, credibility, and the intended action.

11. Final Requirement Check

Requirement	Status
Portfolio submitted with proof statement	PASS
10-second understanding question answered	PASS
10-second credibility question answered	PASS
Real feedback received through permitted AI reviewer format	PASS
Feedback sorted into must-fix vs nice-to-have	PASS
Must-fixes implemented	PASS
Must-fixes addressed on live site	PASS
Feedback engaged with rather than defended	PASS

Submission status: READY